- `Keep-oldest`—Keeps the cluster containing the node with the lowest IP, which is the oldest:
    - *Recommended*—To avoid restarting singletons because they are on the oldest node.
    - *Options*—You can filter the number by role. The default is `down-if-alone=on`, which downs the oldest if it remains as a cluster of one.
    - *Corner case*—If communication breaks down while the oldest node is `Leaving` the cluster before this information is gossiped, the SBR shuts down all nodes: the cluster with the second-oldest node because it did not get the memo, and the one with the oldest node because it expects the other side to continue.

13.4 Cluster singletons

Similar to a singleton in any programming model, a cluster singleton in Akka refers to an actor that has only one instance in the entire cluster. This instance is assigned to the oldest node—that is, the node with the lower IP address—and is automatically moved when its node is removed from the cluster.

Singletons are used in applications for many reasons, but the underlying function is always to provide a single point of access. This can be done to provide a single consistent value, such as a global variable, a cache, or a dictionary. It can be used as a proxy for tunnel communication, such as to provide authentication; as a logger or coordinator, such as a scheduler; and also as a manager, such as a job manager or file system manager.